

md2pdf

A minimal CLI tool that converts Markdown files to PDF using Pandoc and XeLaTeX.

Built while learning Go — focused on real-world tooling and understanding how things work under the hood.

Requirements

- Go 1.20+
- Pandoc
- LaTeX distribution (MiKTeX or TeX Live) with XeLaTeX
- A Unicode font (recommended: Noto Sans)

Usage

```
# Run directly  
go run main.go -in file.md
```

```
# Or build first  
go build -o md2pdf  
./md2pdf -in file.md
```

Internally runs:

```
pandoc input.md -o output.pdf --pdf-engine=xelatex -V geometry:margin=1in
```

What I learned

- Running external commands with `exec.Command`
- How Pandoc converts Markdown → LaTeX → PDF
- Unicode and font handling in XeLaTeX
- Structuring a small but complete CLI tool

Roadmap

v1.x - Custom margin flag - Verbose/debug mode - Unit tests

Next Goals — Desktop app (Wails) - File picker, drag & drop - Output location selector - Progress feedback and status log

Author

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